

# LOST LEGACIES

A lookback at the Indian clubs that once promised greatness but **vanished** from the radar.

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**O**ver the past two decades, Indian football has witnessed the rise and fall of several clubs, many of which folded under the weight of financial strain, poor planning, and systemic neglect.

## **FC Kochin, Kerala**

NFL | Disbanded in 2002

FC Kochin, founded in April 1997, was a pioneering professional football club from Kerala. Nicknamed 'The Elephants', it made history by winning the Durand Cup in its debut year. It was the only Kerala club to play in the NFL in the late 1990s, often finishing strongly. Financial difficulties led to its dissolution around 2002.

## **Fransa-Pax FC, Goa**

NFL | Disbanded in 2006

Founded in 2002 in Goa, Fransa-Pax FC competed in the Goa Professional League before gaining promotion to the NFL in the 2004-05 season, finishing fifth. The club controversially folded halfway through the next season after owner Mickky Pacheco accused the AIFF of conspiring to relegate it, leading to its dissolution in March 2006.

## **Mahindra United FC, Maharashtra**

NFL, I-League | Disbanded in 2010

Mahindra United FC was a Mumbai-based club founded in 1962. The club won numerous honours, including the National Football League and Indian Federation Cup domestic double in the 2005-06 season. Additional accolades include winning the Durand Cup thrice and the IFA Shield twice. However, after the 2009-10 season, the club announced that it was shutting down, with the owners claiming they were going to focus on the group's philosophy of developing sport at the grassroots.

## **JCT FC, Punjab**

NFL, I-League | Disbanded in 2011

Jagatjit Cotton & Textile Football Club (JCT FC, **above in red & white**) was established in 1971 in Phagwara, Punjab. Nicknamed 'The Millmen', it famously won the inaugural National Football League in 1996 and multiple Durand Cups and Federation Cups. It was known for nurturing Indian talent, including Indian legend Sunil Chhetri. The senior team disbanded in 2011, though its academy continues and currently participates in the Punjab State Super Football League.

## **Bengal Mumbai FC, Maharashtra**

NFL Div-2 | Disbanded in 2011

Founded in 1998, Bengal Mumbai

FC aimed to reach the top tier of Indian football. Affiliated with the Mumbai Football Association (MFA), it achieved immediate success in its inaugural year, winning both the Mumbai Football League and the Rovers Cup. The club competed in the NFL Division II before being dissolved in 2011 due to financial and organisational challenges.

## **Viva Kerala FC, Kerala**

NFL, I-League, Kerala Premier League | Disbanded in 2012

Viva Kerala FC, also known as Chirag United Club Kerala, was a team founded in 2004 and based in the city of Kochi. It participated in the NFL, the I-League, and the Kerala Premier League.

The side's only triumph came during the 2005-06 season, when it lifted the KPL title. Following an unsuccessful stint in the I-League in subsequent years, the club was dissolved due to financial distress caused by a lack of proper sponsorship.

## **Travancore Titanium FC, Kerala**

Kerala Premier League and I-League 2 | Disbanded in 2015

Travancore Titanium FC, founded in 1973 and based in present-day Thiruvananthapuram, primarily played in the Kerala Premier League and the Kerala State Club Football Championship, while also



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